B.2 Installing Python

Python is provided through different versions and deployments. This book relies on the standard Python installation, version 3.10. Anaconda is another deployment of Python that is very popular and could be used. However, all the material in this book has been run and tested with a Python 3.10 virtual environment:

1. Go to www.python.org/downloads/.
2. Locate and download the latest release of Python 3.10 for your operating system.
3. Install the release on your machine using the instructions for your operating system.
4. To confirm your installation, open a terminal, and execute the following command:

```
python –-version
```

The version should be 3.10, but if it isn’t, don't worry. You may have multiple Python versions installed. We’ll also confirm the installation when setting up VS Code.

B.3 Installing VS Code

Installing VS Code is relatively straightforward and can be done in just a few steps:

1. Go to https://code.visualstudio.com.
2. Download a stable release of VS Code for your operating system.
3. After the release is downloaded, follow the installation instructions for your operating system.
4. Launch VS Code for your operating system, and make sure no warnings or errors appear. If you encounter problems, try to restart your computer and/or reinstall.